World's Luxury Trains

The world's great luxury rail journeys, organized by region. Compiled 2026-10-06 (41 trains).

Train	Operator	Route	Countries	Region	Note
Bushtracks Express	Bushtracks Africa	Victoria Falls – Victoria Falls Bridge	Zimbabwe	Africa	vintage steam dinner train
Rovos Rail – Pride of Africa	Rovos Rail	Pretoria – Cape Town	South Africa;Botswana;Zimbabwe;Zambia;Tanzania	Africa	luxury rail safari
Royal Livingstone Express	Bushtracks Africa	Livingstone – Victoria Falls Bridge	Zambia	Africa	vintage steam dinner train
The Blue Train	Transnet Freight Rail	Pretoria – Cape Town	South Africa	Africa	overnight sleeper; moving five-star hotel
Deccan Odyssey	Tourism Dept. of Maharashtra / The Royal Journeys	Mumbai – Mumbai (Western/Central India loop)	India	Asia	overnight luxury sleeper; 5-star hotel on wheels
Eastern & Oriental Express	Belmond	Singapore – Bangkok	Singapore; Malaysia; Thailand	Asia	luxury rail cruise; overnight sleeper
Golden Chariot	IRCTC (owned by Karnataka Tourism)	Bengaluru – Bengaluru (South India loop)	India	Asia	overnight luxury sleeper; royal-style cabins
Golden Eagle Silk Road Express	Golden Eagle Luxury Trains	Beijing – Tashkent	China; Kazakhstan; Kyrgyzstan; Tajikistan; Uzbekistan	Asia	luxury rail cruise; overnight sleeper; launched September 2026 (inaugural China departures sold out)
Golden Eagle Vietnam Express	Golden Eagle Luxury Trains	Ho Chi Minh City – Hanoi	Vietnam	Asia	luxury rail cruise; overnight sleeper; launched April 2026
Gran Tenku	Nankai Electric Railway	Osaka Namba – Gokurakubashi (Mount Koya gateway; ~90 min)	Japan	Asia	daytime premium sightseeing train; launched April 24, 2026; 4 cars, ~70 pax; seasonal onboard dining; two daily round trips
Maharajas' Express	IRCTC (Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation)	New Delhi – Mumbai	India	Asia	royal-style palace on wheels; overnight sleeper
Nusantara Explorer	PT Kereta Api Indonesia (KAI)	Java, on-request itineraries (no fixed route published)	Indonesia	Asia	overnight luxury sleeper; launched Sept 29, 2026; 12-car, 36 berths, Grand Restaurant + lounge; whole-train charter and open-trip models; no published routes or commercial details as of Oct 2026
Palace on Wheels	RTDC / Indian Railways	New Delhi – New Delhi (Rajasthan loop)	India	Asia	royal-style palace on wheels; overnight sleeper
Seven Stars in Kyushu	JR Kyushu (Kyushu Railway Company)	Hakata (Fukuoka) – Kyushu loop	Japan	Asia	overnight luxury sleeper cruise train
The Royal Express	Tokyu Corporation (Izu Kyuko)	Yokohama – Izukyu-Shimoda	Japan	Asia	daytime luxury cruise train with fine dining
The Vietage	Anantara (Minor Hotels)	Da Nang – Quy Nhon – Nha Trang	Vietnam	Asia	short luxury daytime railcar experience with dining and spa

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Train Suite Shiki-Shima	JR East (East Japan Railway Company)	Ueno (Tokyo) – Eastern Japan loop	Japan	Asia	overnight luxury sleeper cruise train
Twilight Express Mizukaze	JR West (West Japan Railway Company)	Kyoto – Shimonoseki (also Kyoto – Kyoto loops)	Japan	Asia	overnight luxury sleeper cruise train
Great Southern	Journey Beyond	Adelaide – Brisbane	Australia	Australia	luxury rail cruise; overnight sleeper
Indian Pacific	Journey Beyond	Sydney – Perth	Australia	Australia	luxury rail cruise; overnight sleeper
The Ghan	Journey Beyond	Adelaide – Darwin	Australia	Australia	luxury rail cruise; overnight sleeper
Bernina Express	Rhaetian Railway (RhB)	Chur / St. Moritz – Tirano	Switzerland; Italy	Europe	daytime scenic panoramic (UNESCO route)
Britannic Explorer	Belmond	London – Cornwall / Lake District / Wales (3 nights)	United Kingdom	Europe	overnight sleeper; launched July 2025
British Pullman	Belmond	London Victoria – southern England (roundtrip day excursions)	United Kingdom	Europe	day excursion
Costa Verde Express	Renfe	Bilbao – Santiago de Compostela (6 days)	Spain	Europe	overnight sleeper; Green Spain coastal route
El Transcantábrico Gran Lujo	Renfe	San Sebastián – Santiago de Compostela (8 days)	Spain	Europe	overnight sleeper; 5-star hotel on wheels
Glacier Express (Excellence Class)	Glacier Express AG (Rhätische Bahn / Matterhorn Gotthard Bahn)	St. Moritz – Zermatt	Switzerland	Europe	daytime scenic panoramic (Excellence Class = luxury tier)
Golden Eagle Danube Express	Golden Eagle Luxury Trains	Paris – Istanbul (also Venice – Istanbul Balkan Explorer)	France; Switzerland; Austria; Slovenia; Bulgaria; Turkey	Europe	overnight sleeper; private hotel on wheels; new 14-day Aurelian Odyssey Paris–Cappadocia journey debuted Sept 2026
La Dolce Vita Orient Express	Orient Express (Arsenale / Accor)	Rome – Italy (8 roundtrip itineraries: Venice, Matera, Tuscany, Portofino, Sicily…); Rome – Istanbul 5-day international itinerary from Oct 2026	Italy; Hungary; Romania; Turkey	Europe	overnight sleeper; 1960s La Dolce Vita glamour; Rome–Istanbul 5-day/4-night journey launched Oct 22, 2026, from €20,000pp (return Istanbul–Rome Oct 30)
Royal Scotsman	Belmond	Edinburgh – Scottish Highlands (roundtrip)	United Kingdom	Europe	overnight sleeper; palace on wheels
Tren Al Ándalus	Renfe	Seville – Andalusia (7 days; from 2026 also Madrid – Seville)	Spain	Europe	overnight sleeper; Belle Époque heritage carriages
Venice Simplon-Orient-Express	Belmond	Paris – Venice (flagship; routes also to London, Prague, Budapest, Vienna, Berlin, Istanbul; from 2026 also Paris – Amalfi Coast Villeggiatura series)	France; Italy; United Kingdom; Czechia; Hungary; Austria; Germany; Turkey	Europe	overnight sleeper
Dream of the Desert	Saudi Arabia Railways / Arsenale	Riyadh – Al Jouf – Hail – Riyadh	Saudi Arabia	Middle East	ultra-luxury rail cruise; scheduled to launch Dec 2026
Canyon Spirit	Armstrong Collective (Canyon Spirit)	Denver – Salt Lake City (3 days; also Denver – Moab 2 days)	USA	North America	daytime luxury scenic train with hotel overnights (no sleepers); Rocky Mountaineer US operation rebranded April 2026

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Grand Canyon Railway	Grand Canyon Railway & Hotel (Xanterra)	Williams – Grand Canyon Village	USA	North America	day excursion; Luxury Parlor/Dome class exists
Napa Valley Wine Train	Napa Valley Railroad (NVRR)	Napa – St. Helena	USA	North America	wine-country day excursion; fine dining
Rocky Mountaineer	Rocky Mountaineer	Vancouver – Banff (First Passage to the West)	Canada	North America	daytime scenic panoramic; hotel overnights (no sleepers); Canadian routes only — US operation rebranded as Canyon Spirit
The Canadian (Prestige class)	VIA Rail Canada	Toronto – Vancouver	Canada	North America	overnight sleeper; Prestige class qualifies as luxury (regular long-distance service)
Belmond Andean Explorer	Belmond / PeruRail	Cusco – Arequipa (via Puno)	Peru	South America	overnight luxury sleeper; South America's first luxury sleeper train
Belmond Hiram Bingham	Belmond / PeruRail	Cusco (Poroy) – Aguas Calientes (Machu Picchu)	Peru	South America	luxury day train; fine dining Pullman
PeruRail Titicaca Train	PeruRail	Cusco – Puno	Peru	South America	luxury day train; gourmet lunch and live entertainment